

DA-IICT

Template for Course Offering

1. Course Title	Indian Diaspora and Transnationalism: An Introduction
2. Credit Structure	Lecture hours per week: 3 Tutorial hours per week: 0 Practical hours per week: 0 Total Credits: 3
3. Course Code	HM494
4. Program/Semester	Winter Semester 2026
5. Category	Core / Group Core / Technical Elective / Open Elective / Science Elective
6. Prerequisite courses	None
7. Foundation for	
8. Abstract Content	According to the Ministry of External Affairs of India, thirty-two million two hundred eighty-five thousand four hundred twenty-five Indians live abroad, making it the largest diaspora in the world. Indians have existed transnationally for centuries. Although initially, it was mostly through trade, the concept of international migration is familiar to India. The nature of migration changed over time and circumstances. Various cultural, political, and economic developments transformed the social rubric of India. As a result, the process of migration emerged as one of the means to tackle those unexpected challenges. India's first major tryst with migration began during the 19th-century colonial period, when people from different states migrated to several other 'colonies' of the British as indentured labourers. Over the years, the nature of diasporic communities became more layered, as the individuals of Indian origin made formidable 'connections' with other members of the community– both in their host land and homeland. Indians across the diaspora are linked by a shared 'Indian-ness', an enduring sense of cultural belonging, and the willingness to

	maintain a close association with home. This, however, does not come without its own set of drawbacks - for members of diaspora, homeland, and 'hostland'. The course is designed to familiarise students and critically engage with the topics of present-day diaspora, transnationalism, and international migration. Comprehensive themes include the formation and historical background of the Indian diaspora, overseas experiences of Indians, links with homeland, kinship, and ethnicity.
Suggested Text book(s)	Select books for reference only; a separate course-specific reading list is attached: Brah, Avtar. 2005. <i>Cartographies of Diaspora: Contesting Identities</i>. N.p.: Taylor & Francis. Bauböck, Rainer, and Thomas Faist, eds. 2010. <i>Diaspora and Transnationalism: Concepts, Theories and Methods</i>. N.p.: Amsterdam University Press. Cohen, Robin. 2002. <i>Global Diasporas: An Introduction</i>. N.p.: Taylor & Francis. Lal, Brij V., Peter Reeves, and Rajesh Rai, eds. 2006. <i>The Encyclopedia of the Indian Diaspora</i>. N.p.: University of Hawaii Press. Shukla, Sandhya R. 2003. <i>India Abroad: Diasporic Cultures of Postwar America and England</i>. N.p.: Princeton University Press. Vertovec, Steven, and Robin Cohen, eds. 1999. <i>Migration, Diasporas, and Transnationalism</i>. N.p.: Edward Elgar

Detailed Course Contents		
Topic Name	Content (2 -3 lines per 4 – 6 lectures)	No. of lectures
The Indian diaspora: How did it come to be?	The introductory section explains the notion of ‘diaspora’ and ‘diasporic communities’. Ethnographic case studies central to the emergence and development of ‘Diaspora’ are discussed. Following this, the origins and the formation of the Indian diaspora will be traced across various phases - ancient, modern, and post-modern. Readings will be divided into the following categories: 1) What and who does the term ‘Diaspora’ mean? 2) Emergence of the Indian Diaspora	10
To Be Here and There, At Once: Introduction to Transnationalism	As the diasporic communities formed and sustained themselves abroad, the consistent pattern of maintaining a ‘connection’ with the place of origin, in any form - physical or virtual, became a striking feature. This process is known as ‘transnationalism’. This section introduces and explores the various nuances of this phenomenon, such as are all diasporic communities are transnational. Why do diasporic communities want to be transnational? Are all generations of diaspora transnational? Readings will be grouped under the following categories: 1) What is transnationalism? What does it mean to have a ‘simultaneous existence’? 2) Indian Diaspora and the effect of transnationalism on everyday life	10
Longing to Belong?: Unpacking the Diasporic Identity	The process of migration affixes the importance of an identity that is based on ethnicity, the label obtained from “who you are” and “where you are from”. Though the answers to those questions may not be essentially related to the ethnic origin of a person, the subjectivity that results from such kind of labelling leads to conflict. This conflict manifests itself in different ways – transnational activities, love for the homeland, and a sense of belonging to it. 1) Multiculturalism 2) Class and Caste in Diaspora - Select Case Studies	10 - 12

Indian Diaspora in Bollywood Cinema	This section explains the two-way exchange between the Bollywood Cinema and the Diaspora. The first part explains how the Indian diaspora is portrayed on the screen and how diasporic communities and members relate to ‘Bollywood’. The concepts of kinship, the ‘everyday life’, relationships, and hybrid identities among the diaspora will be discussed through the screening of select movies (mentioned in the course reading list). 1) Introduction to Bollywood and Indian Diaspora 2) Movie Screening(s)	10
Outcomes and Objectives	As an introductory course, the aim is to familiarise students and help them critically engage with concepts of diaspora, transnationalism and international migration. The four themes explained as a part of this course attempt to trace the journey of the members of the diaspora to express themselves - collectively and individually, their position in the ‘host land’ and their changing equation with the concept of ‘home’ and ‘homeland’. The course also discusses the formation of migrant subjectivity and the factors that impact it, thereby addressing the various concerns that the members of the diaspora navigate with, in their daily lives. The objective is also to understand how the Indian diaspora’s engagement with their place of origin changed over the years and the complex reality of being ‘diasporic’.	
Comments	Grading: First In-Semester Examination - 35% Second In-Semester Examination - 35% Group Assignment - 30%	
Explanatory Notes		
Enter a discipline (see master list for guidance) and a first digit followed by xx: 1-4 BTech by year, 5 MTech, 6 MSc, 7 MDes		
Please indicate the program and desired semester in which it is to be offered. Comment on what additional courses in that semester it should not conflict with.		

Appropriate categories: Core (all programs), technical elective, science elective, open elective (BTech), elective (other programs)
Indicate the subsequent courses for which the course would be needed.
The Instructor is permitted a certain degree of flexibility in each course. The following ratios of primary to optional content in terms of lecture hours are given as guidelines: Foundation Courses – 75:25, Track Core (Group Elective)/M.Tech. Specialization Core – 66:33, Electives – 50:50. For example, a 3-0-0-3 course is expected to have 40-42 lectures in the semester, and the primary content should specify 30 lecture hours worth of material in a Foundation Level course and only 20 hours of material in an Elective Course. The primary content is what the instructor must cover in the course; the remaining is at the discretion of the Instructor.
The outcomes and objectives should give, on the one hand, the skills and competencies acquired by the student as well as the value of the course towards industry/research/academic objectives.

Course Outcome:

Course Outcomes and Competencies

Sr. No	Course Outcome	PO/PSO	CPD	KD
1	CO1: Basic critical and analytical understanding of how social and cultural diversity is approached in anthropology, sociology and history.	PO1, PO7, PO12/PSO1	U	F,C
2	CO2: How the diversity of culture, implicit in anthropological, sociological and historical explanations, is to be understood	PO6, PO7, PO8/PSO1, PSO2	U, Ap	F,C,P

CL: Cognitive Process Domain [R: Remember; U: Understand; Ap: Apply; An: Analyze; E: Evaluate; C: Create]

KC: Knowledge Domain [F: Factual; C: Conceptual; P: Procedural; M: Metacognitive]

Focus Area	Yes/ No	Details
Focus on Employability	No	-
Focus on Skill development	Yes	The students develop necessary skills to develop knowledge in culture, society and identity
Focus on entrepreneurship	No	-

POs-COs Matrix:

PO1	PO2	PO3	PO4	PO5	PO6	PO7	PO8	PO9	PO10	PO11	PO12
					X	X	X	X			X

APPENDIX: Detailed Course Content (Session-wise/ Module-wise)

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Appendix - Reading List

Course Title: Indian Diaspora and Transnationalism: An Introduction

Semester: Winter 2026

Instructor: Ratna Bharati B

Readings:

The list of readings is specified according to the themes provided in the course outline.

Theme 1: The Indian diaspora: How did it come to be?

Sub-theme: What and who does the term 'Diaspora' mean?

Clifford, James. 1994. "Diasporas." *Cultural Anthropology* 1 (3): 302-308.

Cohen, Robin. 2002. "Four phases of diaspora studies." In *Global Diasporas: An Introduction*, 1-19. London and New York: Taylor & Francis.

Sub-theme: Emergence of the Indian Diaspora

Cohen, Robin. 2002. "Labour and Imperial Diasporas: Indentured Indians and the British." In *Global Diasporas: An Introduction*, 1-19. London and New York: Taylor & Francis.

Jain, Ravindra K. 2004. "Indian diaspora, old and new: Culture, class and mobility." *Indian Anthropologist* 34 (1): 1-26.

Theme 2: To Be Here and There, At Once: Introduction to Transnationalism

Sub-theme: What is transnationalism? What does it mean to have a 'simultaneous existence'?

Schiller, Nina Glick, Linda Basch, and Cristina Blanc-Szanton. 1992. "Towards a definition of transnationalism." *Annals of the New York Academy of Sciences* 645 (1): ix-xiv.

Levitt, Peggy, and Nina Glick Schiller. 2004. "Conceptualizing Simultaneity: A Transnational Social Field Perspective on Society." *International Migration Review* 38.

Sub-theme: Indian Diaspora and the effect of transnationalism on everyday life

Miller, C. J. 2008. "Immigrants, images and identity: visualising homelands across borders." In *Tracing an Indian Diaspora: Contexts, Memories, Representations*, edited by Parvati Raghuram, Ajaya K. Sahoo, Brij Maharaj, and Dave Sangha, 284-298. N.p.: SAGE Publications.

Ballard, Roger. 2003. "The South Asian presence in Britain and its transnational connections." In *Culture and Economy in the Indian Diaspora*, edited by Bhikhu Parekh, Gurharpal Singh, and Steven Vertovec, 209-234. London & New York: Taylor & Francis.

Anderson, Benedict. 1998. "Long-distance nationalism." *The Spectre of Comparisons: Nationalism, Southeast Asia and the World* 58: 74-88.

Theme 3: Longing to Belong?: Unpacking the diasporic Identity

Sub-theme: Identity

Hall, Stuart. 2015. "Cultural Identity and Diaspora". In *Colonial Discourse and Post-Colonial Theory*: 392-403. Routledge.

Vertovec, Steven. 2001. "Transnationalism and Identity." *Journal of Ethnic and Migration Studies* 27 (4): 573–82. doi:10.1080/13691830120090386.

Sub-theme: Gender and Caste in Indian Diaspora

Upadhyay, Nishant. 2019. "Making of "model" South Asians on the tar sands: Intersections of race, caste, and indigeneity." *Critical Ethnic Studies* 5 (1-2): 152-173.

Grieco, Elizabeth M. 1998. "The effects of migration on the establishment of networks: Caste disintegration and reformation among the Indians of Fiji." *International Migration Review* 32 (3): 704-736

Ralson, Helen. 1997. "Arranged, 'semi-arranged' and 'love marriages among South Asian immigrant women in the diaspora and their non-migrant sisters in India and Fiji: A comparative study." *International Journal of Sociology of the Family*: 43-68.

Theme 4: The Indian diaspora and Bollywood

Sub-theme: Introduction to the Indian diaspora and Bollywood

Dwyer, Rachel. 2014. "Bollywood'S Empire: Indian cinema and the diaspora." In *Routledge Handbook of the South Asian Diaspora*, edited by Joya Chatterji and David Washbrook, 409-419. London & New York.: Taylor & Francis.

Therwath, Ingrid. 2010. "'Shining Indians': Diaspora and Exemplarity in Bollywood." *South Asia Multidisciplinary Academic Journal* 4.

Vernstappen, Sandrien, and Mario Rutten. 2007. "Bollywood and the Indian Diaspora: Reception of Indian Cinema among Hindustani youth in the Netherlands." In *Global Indian Diasporas: Exploring Trajectories of Migration and Theory*, edited by Gijsbert Oonk. N.p.: Amsterdam University Press.

Sub-theme: Movie Screening and Discussion of Related Readings

Movie Screening 1: Mississippi Masala (1991)

Director: Mira Nair

Reading for Movie Discussion: Desai, Jigna. 2004. "When Indians Play Cowboys: Diaspora and Post-Coloniality in Mississippi Masala." In *Beyond Bollywood: The Cultural Politics of South Asian Diasporic Film*, 71-101. London & New York: Taylor & Francis.

Movie Screening 2: Namesake (2006)

Director: Mira Nair

Reading for Movie Discussion: Paudyal, Binod. 2015. "Reimagining Transnational Identities in Lahiri's The Namesake." *South Asian Review* 36 (2): 195-214.